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Culture (OWC): [Chagga \(FN04\)](#)

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Sub Region: Eastern Africa

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Section Title(S): 21. Age Grades

"Your orders must be clear, and you must unite your people at the right time. Then they will be glad to have a unifier. Vika sitambasaka ifo sihongon: On the settled hills you should place spies. We say that you have the eye of an eagle that spies into every district. But if you remain too self-reliant, you remain blind in the end. You must place a spy in every district, 351 a spy whom you pay for his services with meat and cloth. He will tell you whatever there is worthy of note. Then you can call in the district officials and the elders and you will be able to tell them what frightens you and what you are amazed at.

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Chief Executive

"Mongolulu fo kisahen, na fovitsuo, ria — ho ngutsu imu: Take a mouthful of uncooked banana gruel even if it tastes horrible.

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Chief Executive

"If a leper comes to you and wants to talk to you, do not despise him but go into the banana grove with him and listen to what he has to say. He may be the only one who has been kept officially kept out of a plot, and he may have come to inform you about the plot.

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Chief Executive

"Kokumba msefu kosefuo oruka lukawa ngafu ni kindo kjafo ijo: It is your business if you should decide to squeeze the country dry so that it becomes a heap of poverty. Chieftain! Do not send a beer-spy around who is to find out for you where they might brew some beer at the moment. These roaming spies eat up one half before they bring you the other half. And this would make people shy and distrusting. If a peasant has brewed beer in your country and if he brings some of it to you, receive the gift without mental reservation. Should his neighbor come later and accuse him of having brewed many a barrel, do not earmark the peasant for punishment, for that would destroy his property; give him a warning in a joking manner, and he will express his gratitude with a gift.

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Chief Executive

"You must remember: just as the wives of one man contend for the favor of the joint husband so the men fight for the favor of the chieftain.

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Chief Executive

"Ulawade oruka otsilunjamara tsa Orombo. Orombo kawona mwengeria kahamba mboduo kanjamara newaha, oruka loke lukanjama — rika: do not take over the country in order to destroy it like Orombo. When Orombo saw the increase of children, he said: 'These are small fry!', and he killed them so that his country perished. Chieftain! Do not ruin your country with your ire. When Orombo was still a young fellow  318 he gave orders to encircle the hyenas with fire and to burn them. Thereupon the survivors have sung the song of cursing for him. Moreover, he gave orders to kill all lizards because one of them had gotten into his mouth when he drank in haste. When he was chieftain he gave orders to kill all short children because he wanted to have only tall people (makisawu, i.e., steep staircases) around him as he was a tall man himself. Hence the Wangumai and the Masai had it very easy with the other chieftains when they exhorted them to betray Orombo.

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Chief Executive

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